

Months later, Naomi began to believe that Ben was right. The pressures on their marriage eased as a result of the bankruptcy, which lessened the financial strain from their delinquent bills. In addition, Ben was able to work extra overtime as his company increased its productivity. They were thrilled with their baby son, Timmy, and they used the extra income from Ben's overtime to buy baby supplies and the other items they needed.

Naomi's mind was so occupied with caring for Timmy that she rarely thought of the bankruptcy. Her mother stayed and helped her until the baby was nearly a month old before returning to her own home.

On her own without her mom's help, Naomi's stress level was higher, but it was still manageable. Unfortunately, Ben pushed Naomi's stress level over the limit when he again became lax in taking care of the household bills. In addition, he began to pick up food in the evenings rather than eat at home.

"There just doesn't seem to be enough money each month," Ben complained. "There was for a while, but it seems to evaporate. We just can't make it on my salary, Naomi. Most couples we know have to have two incomes. That's reality."

"But who would take care of Timmy if I went back to work?" Naomi asked as the tears began to flow. She felt like she was in a dark pit with the sides beginning to cave in.

"Maybe we can get your mom to, at least for a while, until we can get some of the bills caught up," Ben said.

"I hate doing that," Naomi replied. "We're always having to ask for someone's help."

Naomi did go back to work and found that she actually enjoyed it. Although she missed Timmy, being away from him during the day helped her to cope with being up with him at night.

But after a few weeks, her mother told her that, much as she loved and enjoyed her grandson, she could no longer take care of him every day. Naomi fretted over the decision, but in the end she knew her mother was right, so she started looking for someone else.